

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

Why cold outreach still works in 2026.

And what has to change about yours for it to work for you.



@csos

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COLD OUTREACH IS A VOLUME GAME

If you cannot play volume, do not attempt it at all.

If you can, it is the fastest way to prove to yourself and to the market that you can hold a conversation with a stranger.

01

"WILL IT NOT HURT MY BRAND?"

If you are relying on cold outreach as a creative strategist, your brand is not yet the thing bringing in the work.

A brand that does not exist cannot be hurt by outreach.

02

IT TEACHES YOU TO TALK TO STRANGERS

Hundreds of first messages sent, hundreds of replies read, hundreds of opening lines tested.

The skill does not leave you once you have it. It shows up on every sales call for the rest of your career.

WHAT TO SEND

NOT THIS

A pitch, a services page link, a rate, a calendar link, or "Are you open to a call this week?"

THIS

A screenshot of one of their ads, with three sentences on what you would test next.

THE STRUCTURE

1 One specific observation about their business that you actually saw.

2 One specific idea for what you would test next and why.

3 No ask at the end. Just "That is the thought, reply if it lands."

4

5

WHAT KILLS THE REPLY

A compliment about their content, a vague offer, a link to a services page, a rate, or a calendar link.

Any of these signals to the prospect that they have read your message a thousand times before.

THE NUMBERS TO EXPECT

Ten messages sent properly will get you a handful of replies.

A handful of replies will get you a paid conversation.

Most creative strategists give up before they have sent twenty.

THE ALTERNATIVE

If you can pay for Facebook ads for yourself, run those instead of outreach.

Ads are a cleaner version of the same thing.

If you cannot afford ads yet, outreach is the road back to being able to.

NEXT STEP

Want a read on where you are?

Take the creative strategy test at
creativestrategyos.com/quiz.

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